

unattributed-commit-guard

scripts/hooks/unattributed-commit-guard.sh — unattributed-commit detector

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-08-21T19:55:00Z **Purpose:** §11.4.84 / §11.4.238 guard that finds commits landing on this repository with no attribution — no tracked-item id, no task, no PR reference. **Last verified:** 2026-08-21

Overview

A commit whose entire subject is Auto-commit (or sync: ...) and whose body carries no BOB-NNN / task / PR reference cannot be traced to the work that motivated it. That is a §11.4.238 discovery problem rather than a style complaint: when such a commit later turns out to have introduced a defect, there is no item to reopen (§11.4.214) and no review to point at (§11.4.142).

This guard makes that population **mechanically visible** instead of something a human notices while reading `git log`.

MEASURED on this repository, 2026-08-21: **21** bare Auto-commit subjects exist across all refs, and **14** commits violate the rule in the default range (`v1.0.0-rc..HEAD`) — 11 bare Auto-commit plus 2 sync: ..., the latter class missed entirely by the narrower grep that preceded this guard.

Prerequisites

- A git working tree (the guard reads history only; it never writes).
- git on PATH. No network, no container runtime, no credentials.

Usage

```
bash scripts/hooks/unattributed-commit-guard.sh          #
default range
bash scripts/hooks/unattributed-commit-guard.sh --range A..B  #
explicit range
bash scripts/hooks/unattributed-commit-guard.sh --self-test  #
§11.4.107(10)
```

Default range is “since the last tag reachable from HEAD”.

Exit status: 0 clean, non-zero when violations are found (each named).

Edge cases

- **A referenced Auto-commit is NOT a violation.** A commit may keep the bare subject provided its body cites an item; the guard’s false-positive control needle covers exactly this case, so a legitimately-attributed commit is never flagged (§11.4.201(1) — a false refusal is as forbidden as a false pass).
- **Merge commits** inherit their subject from git and are not authored prose.
- **An empty range** (no commits since the last tag) is a clean 0, not an error.

Internal behaviour

The subject pattern set is CLOSED and explicit rather than heuristic: matching “anything that looks low-effort” would produce exactly the false refusals §11.4.201(1) forbids. A commit is a violation only when its subject matches the closed set AND the FULL message carries no reference.

--self-test ships golden-good, golden-bad, and the false-positive control needle, and is the §11.4.107(10) self-validation: a guard never observed FAILing on a genuinely-broken input is unvalidated instrumentation (§11.4.115(F)).

Paired §1.1 mutation (verified): neutering the pattern match makes the self-test FAIL and makes the real scan silently report OK against 21 known violations — the exact bluff. Restored, the file is sha256-identical and the scan again names the 14.

Known gap — read this before trusting a green run

This guard is not yet wired into any seam. It runs when a human types it, so it is not standing detection pressure (§11.4.226 — registration is not coverage). Wiring it as-is would refuse every commit immediately, because the 14 pre-existing violations are real and cannot be fixed in the moment; that is a §11.4.224(E) brownfield-adoption decision the operator owns, tracked as **BOB-162** with the options enumerated. Until that answer is recorded, a clean run of this guard means only “the range you asked about is clean”.

Related

- `tests/hooks/test_unattributed_commit_guard.sh` — 9 real-invocation assertions
- `docs/history/BOB-079-attributed-auto-commit-history.md` — the attribution record built FROM this guard’s output (BOB-079)
- `scripts/hooks/check-brief-inputs.sh` — sibling dispatch-hygiene guard